GymBuddy — Your Simple Start to Fitness

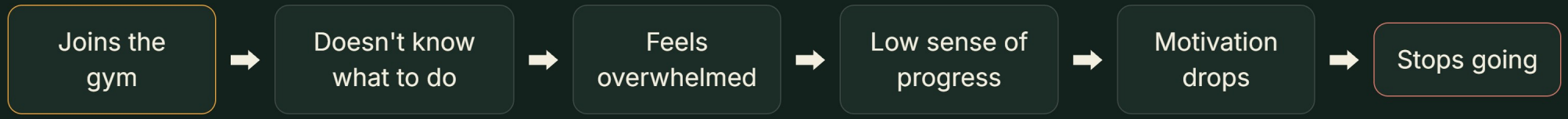
Beginner gym-goers often struggle to stay consistent because workouts can feel overwhelming, time-consuming, and difficult to navigate. They need a simpler way to start, complete manageable workouts, and see progress that gives them a sense of accomplishment.

The consistency gap — general population context, not gym-specific

44.3%
reported lack of motivation as a barrier

19.8%
reported not having enough time

CDC survey of 525 men who did not meet or did not know whether they met physical-activity recommendations; respondents could select multiple barriers. Source: CDC — Preventing Chronic Disease, cdc.gov/pcd/issues/2025/24_0268a.htm



User Persona

> "I want to lose weight and feel healthier, but the workouts feel heavy and I get tired very quickly."



Pooja

25 years | Chennai

Weight Loss

Recently joined a gym and wants to get fitter, but feels overwhelmed by workouts and often loses motivation.

Situation and context

Goes to the gym about once a week. Follows random exercises from online videos and feels exhausted in a short time.

Goals and motivations

Lose weight, feel fitter and follow a simple, manageable routine. Wants to see progress and feel good about showing up.

Biggest frustrations

Workouts feel too heavy, gets tired quickly and loses motivation. Often doesn't know if she's doing the exercises correctly.

How they currently approach it

Searches workout videos online, tries exercises suggested by friends or trainers, but often skips due to tiredness or lack of time.

> "I want to build muscle and be consistent, but I'm not always sure what to do and it's hard to stick to a routine on busy days."



Dev

24 years | Chennai

Muscle Building

Goes to the gym 2–3 times a week and wants to build muscle. Spends enough time at the gym but struggles with consistency and a clear plan.

Situation and context

Goes to the gym 2–3 times a week. Looks up exercises online but still feels confused about what to do, especially on busy days.

Goals and motivations

Build muscle and strength, follow a structured routine easily and stay consistent over time.

Biggest frustrations

Not sure if he's doing the right exercises, finds it hard to stay consistent with work and other commitments. Sometimes workouts feel repetitive and boring.

How they currently approach it

Searches workouts online, tries different routines and sometimes follows advice from gym trainers or friends.

> "I want to stay fit and healthy, but I don't have much time and it's hard to make gym a habit."



Nirmitha

26 years | Chennai

Stay Fit

Wants to stay fit and healthy, but her busy schedule and personal commitments make it hard to invest proper time in the gym. She goes only a few times a month.

Situation and context

Goes to the gym a few times a month. Tries to follow workouts from online content but struggles to invest enough time and finds it difficult to stay consistent.

Goals and motivations

Stay fit and healthy, feel more energetic and build a habit without spending too much time.

Biggest frustrations

Lack of time, finds it hard to stay consistent and workouts feel overwhelming. Often doesn't feel a sense of accomplishment.

How they currently approach it

Searches short and easy workouts online, sometimes tries home workouts, but often skips due to time constraints or lack of motivation.

Insights and User Segment

Supporting research — 5 beginner-fitness discussions

Long, exhausting workouts — a 1.5+ hour session left one beginner exhausted midway. r/beginnerfitness

Feeling overwhelmed — overwhelmed within 15 minutes; wanted a 30–45 min routine. r/beginnerfitness

Not knowing where to start — a nervous first-timer unsure how to use gym machines. r/beginnerfitness

Time and consistency — busy schedule, slipping routine, fear of injury. r/beginnerfitness

Motivation and consistency — struggling to motivate themselves to start. r/beginnerfitness

Key insight

Heavy, confusing, time-consuming workouts → overwhelm → difficulty staying consistent.

This supporting research reinforced the patterns found in direct user conversations.

V1 target user: beginner / inconsistent gym-goers who feel overwhelmed by workouts, have limited time, and struggle to stay motivated.

Product opportunity: help beginners make workouts feel manageable and give them a simple way to track progress toward a goal.

"I don't know where to start, and workouts feel heavy" → "Give me a simple workout and a visible goal + progress loop."

Defining the V1

Target user: beginner / inconsistent gym-goers who feel overwhelmed by workouts, have limited time, and struggle to stay motivated.

V1 problem: make it easier for beginners to know what to do, complete a manageable workout, and see their progress.

Product hypothesis — not yet proven

If beginners are given manageable workouts and a simple way to track self-set goals, they may find it easier to complete workouts, feel a sense of accomplishment, and return more consistently.

V1 — build now

- Simple onboarding + goal understanding
- Manageable workout options
- Completion tracking
- Self-set monthly target
- Progress tracking + streak

V2 — build later

- Personalised AI workout recommendations
- Adaptive workout difficulty
- Deeper progress insights
- More personalised guidance
- AI-based workout adjustments

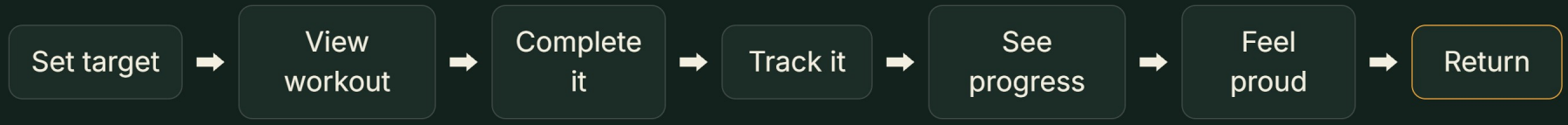
Cut — not building now

- Social / community features
- Advanced nutrition tracking
- Complex fitness analytics
- Full personal-trainer replacement
- Large fitness content library

Prioritised the pain point that recurred most, mattered most to consistency, and could be tested fastest with real users.

GymBuddy: Make Showing Up Feel Achievable

Problem: I don't know what to do, workouts feel heavy and time-consuming, and I struggle to stay consistent.



Simple workouts
Reduces "where do I start?"

Self-set monthly goal
Creates ownership and accountability

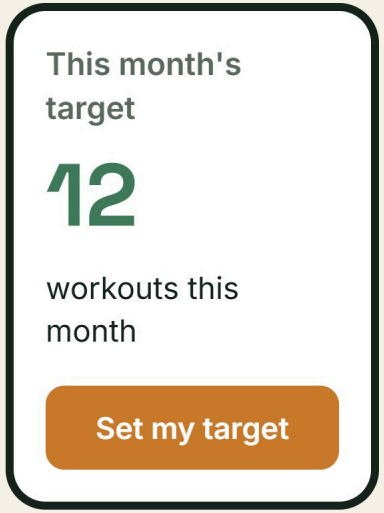
Progress tracking
Makes effort visible

Streak
A simple loop around showing up

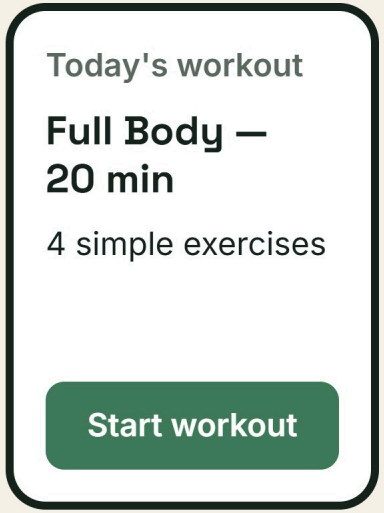
Intended product mechanisms

MVP idea: GymBuddy gives beginners simple workouts to follow and a lightweight progress loop that makes their effort visible.

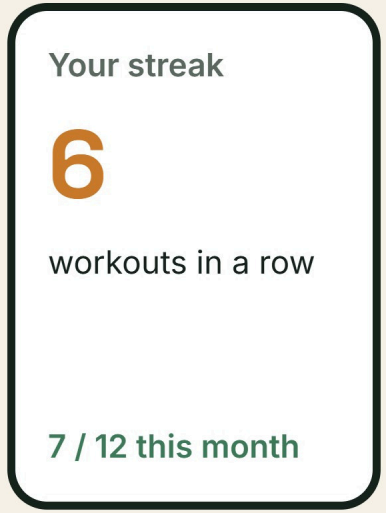
What I Built



1. Set a monthly target



2. Follow a manageable workout



3. Track accomplishment

Concept mockups of the prototype's core screens.

🔗 View GymBuddy Prototype

Implementation

V1 prototype built using AI-assisted development (Claude), focused on validating the core experience rather than a complete fitness platform.

Core build: onboarding → goal setting → workout → completion tracking → progress + streak.

Challenge

Implementing AI too early, without enough user behaviour data, would have added unnecessary complexity and made personalisation unreliable.

Decision

Prioritised tracking user behaviour and validating the core experience first — AI personalisation follows once enough data exists to make it meaningful.

How I Would Measure Whether It Works

Current status

V1 prototype built. Real-user validation is the next step.

Primary metric

Core workout completion rate

What we'll track: tried it, completed the core action, would use again, actually returned, monthly target & streak continuation, plus qualitative signals on difficulty, clarity, and motivation — to be validated with real users.

Risks & product trade-offs

Risk	Mitigation
Low initial adoption Medium	Start with beginner/inconsistent gym-goers who closely match the target user and test through gyms, communities, and direct outreach.
Workouts may still feel too heavy High	Test workout duration and difficulty with users; simplify or adjust based on feedback and completion behaviour.
AI may not be reliable early on Medium	Delay AI personalisation until enough user behaviour data is available; validate the core experience first.
Workout safety High	Keep V1 workouts simple and beginner-oriented, with appropriate safety guidance.

From V1 to Real-World Learning

"GymBuddy is for beginners who want to get fit but feel overwhelmed by complicated or heavy workouts. It gives you a simple workout to follow, lets you set your own monthly target, and shows your progress so every workout feels like an achievement."

First users

Beginner / inconsistent gym-goers · people intimidated by heavy workouts · time-poor, low-motivation joiners

Channels

Nearby gyms · Cult.fit · housing-society gyms · friends & colleagues who fit the profile · fitness communities

Next iteration

1. Test with real beginner gym-goers
2. Identify the biggest drop-off
3. Understand why it happens
4. Iterate based on evidence
5. Introduce AI only if behaviour data shows a validated need

Future experiments: personalised recommendations · adaptive difficulty · AI adjustments · deeper insights · retention & referral loops

The goal of GymBuddy V1 is not to build the most feature-rich fitness app — it's to learn whether making workouts more manageable and progress more visible can help beginners keep showing up.